ICONOGRAPHIC ANALYSIS OF 'A HEALTHY MEAL'

*Candidate's artwork 'A Healthy Meal'
Oil on Canvas, April 2022

CONCEPT

I was inspired by a painting called, 'Dominus Aeris escape -5' by Thukral and Tagra to use surrealism to express my views on vegetarianism. The piece emphasises the contrasts between the dreams of voiceless animals like cows and the ease with which meat is consumed today. The illogical interplay of objects aid in conveying what the phrases in the poem, 'A Healthy Meal' by Carol Ann Duffy mean to me.

ICONOGRAPHIC ANALYSIS

Iconographic analysis is the exploration of icons and symbols in an artwork to find the purpose and meaning of the work. To conceptually interpret the icons, the context of the work must be known - including the influences on the work, external factors that lead to the work, and the artist's perspective.

https://human.libretexts.org/Bookshelves/Art/Art_History_II_(Lumen)/01%3A_Introduction/1.11%3A_Iconographic_Analysis-_Understanding_Iconography#:~:text=In%20iconographic%20analyses%2C%20art%20historians,people%20that%20produced%20the%20work
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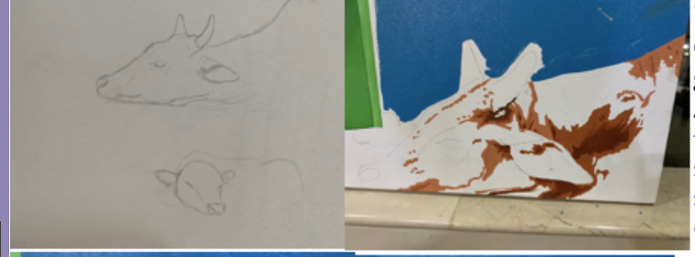
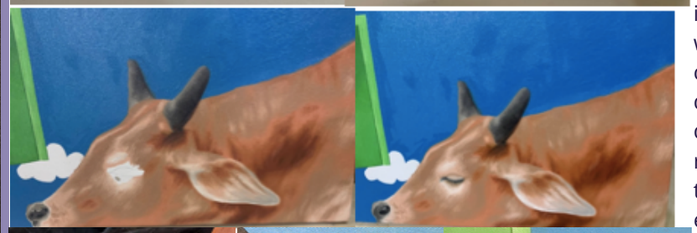
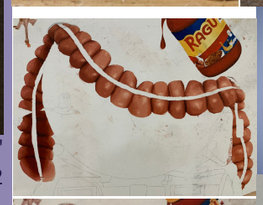
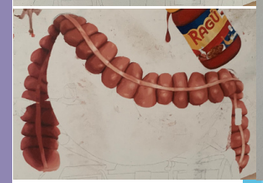








"The gourmet tastes the secret dreams of cows tossed lightly in garlic."

As suggested by the first line of the poem, the cow as well as the cloud near it are symbolic for a cow's dreams which sets the surrealistic style of the painting. The light colours of the clouds show us the innocence of animals. The cow is painted with closed eyes in a realistic style while the cloud is painted in a flat pink colour with a darker pink outline. This throws light on the difference between what is represented as reality and as a dream. The brushstrokes that show the texture of fur on the cow emphasise the fact that a cow is a living breathing animal, whereas, the solid colour in the cloud represents something non-existent. The border around the clouds is a symbol for the boundaries that humans cross and that cows dream of having.

"Behind the green door, swish of oxtails languish on an earthen dish."

This line is contrasted by the artwork as the door seems to have nothing behind it. The emptiness symbolises how humans enter nature and take all of her resources, kill all her animals until there is absolutely nothing left.

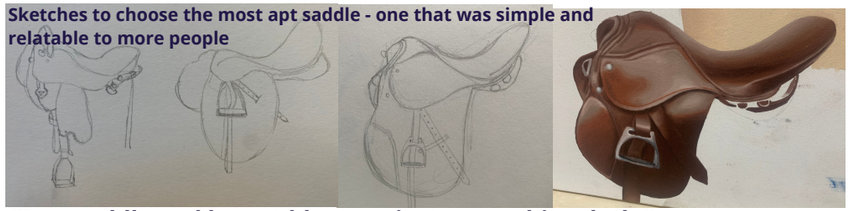
Digitally editing images to then use as a reference to paint

"Death moves in the bowels."

In this painting, the icon of the bowel is oddly placed above the tongue which seems to be unnatural according to the human digestive system. Even though death is said to move in the bowels, the tongue below represents the underlying reason for this intake of "death" which is, according to the artist, taste. As mentioned in the poem, **"tongues braised in armagnac"** shows how the tongue then washes away the guilt with a sip of expensive wine. The position of the Armagnac on the menu symbolises an end point. However, the bowels also represent how the dead animals spend hours in the intestines to digest while the thought is easily forgotten within seconds.

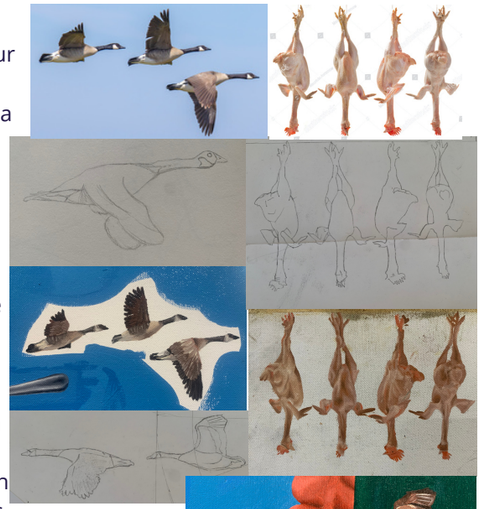
PROCESS

Analysis of the poem and visualisation of phrases.



"Leg, saddle and breast bleat against pure white cloth."

The leather saddle marks the beginning of the contrasts seen in the artwork. The leather saddle opposite the cow is an icon to show what happens to the dreams of innocent animals such as cows. In our society, leather is not used for survival purposes but instead it is used as a sign of luxury and wealth. This contrast is also brought out through the difference in textures and the difference in the shades of brown in the cow and the saddle.



"Capped teeth chatter to a kidney or at the breast of something which once flew."

Humans allow some birds to fly freely while others are killed, chopped and hung on the streets to be sold. This is ironic as birds flying are a symbol of peace. The dead chickens hung at the slaughterhouse are painted in colours of human skin to remind the audience that the chickens were breathing, living animals which are often forgotten or ignored. The texture of the chickens are also smooth as compared to the freely flying, coloured swans where the paint shows a slight impasto technique to bring out the feathers that birds represent their autonomy, whereas, the smoothness in the chickens represents the harsh processes carried out on them that remove the defining features of birds from them. The roughness and the thickness of the paint of the swans with visible brushstrokes are symbolic of the freedom of nature and its beauty that doesn't require any perfectionism or neatness.

Experimentation with composition inspired by Thukral and Tagra

PROCESS CONTD.

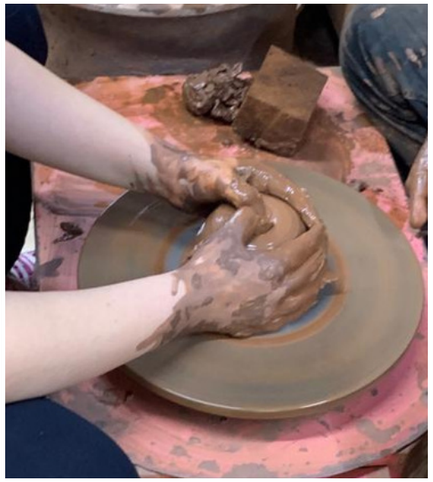
Experimentation with icons and composition.
Painting one icon at a time using oil paints.
A flat layer of the background in the end.

Pottery wheel throwing

*Candidate's artwork
After baking each of the pots, I painted them using 5 colours and arranged them to represent my interpretation of people - everyone unique as represented by the shapes yet similar as represented by the colours used

I was interested in pottery as it is based on the circular motion and mechanics of rotation as I studied in physics. In India, it is common to find small, local tea stalls serving 'masala chai' (Indian) in clay pots or 'kulhars' made from wheel pottery. These kulhars could be reproduced with precision due to forces acting at the same point on the rotating clay.

Start with throwing the clay onto the wheel and applying pressure so that it centres itself due to the circular motion, and vertical motion could be used to build a foundation of shape called coning.



Use your thumbs to start creating a depression. Apply more pressure downwards and outwards to enlarge the interior while the rest of your hands maintain a circular shape.

Use two/more fingers inside the pot (according to how large the interior is) and your thumb or palm of the other hand outside the pot and move them simultaneously from the bottom to the top applying a slight pressure to achieve a uniform thickness throughout.

Finally, to get your desired shape pressure from the outside can be used to make the pot narrower and pressure from the inside can be used to make the pot broader.

Then, for artistic purposes once the fundamental shape is achieved we can use tools and our fingers and get creative with adding pressure to form bulges and cavities.

After you're happy with your pot, you can then cut it off the wheel using a thread.

Reflection

After experimenting with the wheel and learning some age old techniques over multiple days, two things I learnt to keep in mind while doing pottery on the wheel were-

Pressure-

After producing multiple asymmetrical pots, I inferred that in order to achieve smoothness and symmetry, pressure had to be applied using my whole body. By sitting with my elbows resting on my legs I learnt that I was able to create uniformity and increase and control my pressure with ease.

Movement-

As I was amazed by the creations of others at the wheel, I instantly tried to form a shape out of the clay. However, with the help of my teacher, I learnt about patience, control, and following certain hand movement techniques. Certain hand postures and movements along with correctly utilising my body weight for pressure allowed me to move my hands slowly and with precision. Looking at this mechanically, I realised that applying pressure to create a shape while moving my hands upwards slowly was almost like I was shaping the pot at every instant, as if the pot were made of an infinite number of rings.

What I found hard was the process of cutting the pot off the wheel. It was quite frustrating as I destroyed many pots while learning this process. However, with practice and tips from my teacher I was able to cut the smaller pots with ease in the end.

Uses of the potter's wheel

A potter's wheel can be used to make even and symmetrical circular pots and sculptures, which are easily replicable, by throwing and shaping clay quickly. The wheel can also be used to work on semi-dry pots to add designs by carving through the unbaked clay. Pottery is found in multiple different forms and materials throughout India and is used for multiple purposes such as for serving food and drinks, cooking food, decoration, storage, etc. It's often made by small businesses and sold in bulk to food producers or in stalls. It is deeply rooted in India's history since the terracotta vessels of the Indus Valley and has taken multiple forms with India's ever-growing culture along with the formation of a community of potters known as 'Kumhars'. Pottery in India is of 2 types - glazed or unglazed, however unglazed pots are far more common as glazed pottery is only practiced in some parts of the country.

https://food.ndtv.com/food-drinks/kulhad-the-traditional-clay-cups-from-ancient-india-and-its-benefits-1754901 https://thepotterywheel.com/what-is-wheel-throwing/
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aNS0INXx6LE https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Kumhar https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Pottery_in_the_Indian_subcontinent#Styles

GRAPHICS TO FASHION

The tiger, being the Indian national animal and a symbol for courage, has highly impacted my image of myself. Previously, I have used it in a charcoal artwork and in a painting using acrylic paint.

BACKSTITCH PROCESS

While stitching the tiger, I learned how large each stitch size must be. When my stitches were too small in length, the fabric of the T-shirt began to fold because of the tension in the thread and the resultant line was not as accurate as I'd like it to be. However, when my stitches were too large, the curves in my lines seemed flattened and the thread did not stay attached to the fabric as it bent. Finally, I found the most optimum stitch length to be approximately 2mm as it provided stitches that were flexible with the thin material of the T-shirt. I realised that while stitching straight lines I could make my stitches slightly long while on curved lines, I varied the length of my stitches. I picked the backstitch because even though it requires the most thread, it forms the most strong and permanent stitches. However, this caused the entire motif to be heavy for the weight of my T-shirt and therefore, it requires to be handled delicately.

SIMPLIFICATION is a very important graphic design method used by designers to make graphics more memorable and immediately recognizable, and is utilized in logos, symbols, posters, computer icons, and other design applications.

EMBROIDERY TECHNIQUE CHOICE

There are multiple embroidery techniques that I could use to depict the tiger and the bird like patchwork embroidery, shadow work embroidery or counted thread embroidery. However, I chose to use outline embroidery for the tiger to represent the boldness of a tiger, using only black threads to provide a stark contrast to the light pink background. I felt bead embroidery was best suited for the bird as it allowed for the interplay between multiple different colours, textures and patterns.

TIGER GRAPHIC LOGOS

Princeton University

KENZO

TIGER BALM®

To me, **a bird** is a symbol for beauty, peace and freedom. Therefore, I wanted to use images of these animals as motifs for T-shirts

BEAD EMBROIDERY PROCESS

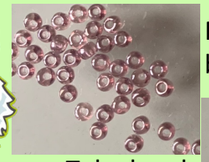
In bead embroidery, I learned the Indian technique called Tambour Beading. Tambour literally means a circular frame for holding fabric taut while it is being embroidered. Using a chain stitch each bead or sequin is attached to the fabric one at a time, resulting in highly accurate designs. However, while using these stitches and techniques on fine knit cotton T-shirts, I saw how using a thinner thread gave me more control in placing the beads and sequins. Making each stitch the exact length of the bead or sequin was extremely important.

https://handembroidery.com/what-is-tambour-beading/ https://www.frontend.ink/what-are-the-different-types-of-embroidery-techniques/blog/ https://www.hunarcourses.com/blog/types-of-hand-embroidery-techniques/ https://phulkariembroidery.wordpress.com/2017/02/21/motifs-and-colors-of-phulkari/ https://ri.ritukumar.com/in/m/zardozi-sarees

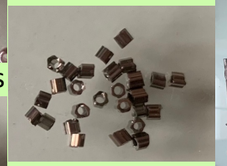
ZARDOSI AND BIRDS While zardozi embroidery is a broad term that encompasses all forms of work with gold, the inspiration for all motifs has always been nature. From flowers, leaves and trees, to animals and birds, the national ecology of India seeps into all zardozi embroidery. Today, the craft has become a mainstay in couture and bridal costumery. The Indian fashion designer Ritu Kumar makes a skillful use of it in her Zardozi Sarees that cater to the Indian tradition, aesthetics and conception of luxury of her audience.

PHULKARI AND BIRDS Phulkari is a traditional embroidery art form that originated in the Punjab region of India and Pakistan. It involves the use of vibrant thread work to create intricate floral and geometric designs on fabrics such as shawls, dupattas, and sarees. Animals and birds represented success, beauty, pride, and goodwill and different fruits symbolized wealth, prosperity, and fertility. Depending on the region, different birds may be depicted in phulkari embroidery.

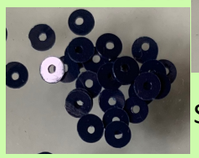
MATERIALS AND TOOLS



Round beads

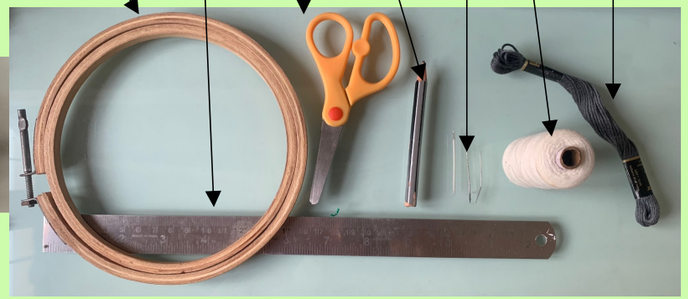


Tube beads



Sequins

Embroidery hoop
Ruler
Scissors
Pencil
Embroidery needles
Satin thread
Cotton thread



Lobo!

BACKGROUND

Lobo is a Brazilian artist who had a unique approach to pop art that gained recognition in the 1960s and 1970s. Lobo's work was influenced by a number of Brazilian artists, including Hélio Oiticica and Lygia Clark, who were associated with the Neo-Concrete movement in Brazil in the 1950s and 1960s. The neo-concrete movement was a short-lived Brazilian movement that focused on art belonging to the experiences and feelings of an individual as opposed to a culture or period.

APPROACH TO POP ART

When he moved to New York City, he incorporated Brazilian motifs along with bright colours and bold lines that reflected the energy of Brazilian culture. We can see the influences of Andy Warhol and Roy Lichtenstein as well in his works as he adhered to the pop art style using images from mass media in his pieces. Thus, he brought in global influence on the art world in New York City.

Patterns like Ben Day dots within regions add to the maximalist style and absence of negative space to create repetition which all challenge the abstract expressionism prevalent in NYC.

*New York Pop Art - LOBO

Thick and thin outlines to provide a 3-d effect

Colour contrasts

No outlines where colours contrast to create a subtle background

Incorporated elements of Brazilian art in pop art like striking colours and tropicalism

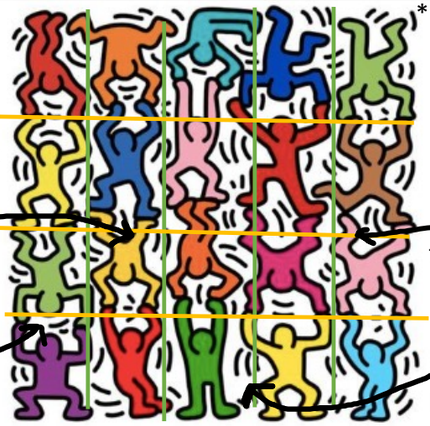
Vibrant, striking colours – attributed to Brazilian styles, in Pop art context: use of colours directly from the tube

Images from daily life in New York taken out of context like a collage

DIFFERENCES BETWEEN LOBO AND KEITH HARING

Lobo's work is more abstract whereas Haring's is easier to interpret. Lobo's includes work is heavily influenced by his Brazilian roots while Haring's is influenced by the NYC, from the music to the issues to his experiences there. While Lobo often incorporates words into his works, Haring sticks to using symbols to make his work more universal. This is because Haring's work typically has a message while Lobo's is more playful. Even though both follow the vibrant colours of pop art, Lobo's work is busier due to his use of patterns to fill up negative spaces and his lack of uniformity, chaotic composition and partial outlines.

Keith Haring®



* 'Acrobats'- Keith Haring

Repetition of Pop art brought out in the regular composition structure of a grid

Negative space covered using curved lines – create a sense of movement and maximalism

Uniform outlines – freedom in style reflects the ideas behind pop art of irony

Pattern in the foreground created by the repetition of figures in a 5 by 4 form.

Small curved lines in groups of 2 and 3 only in black to emphasise repetition and ordinary

Vibrant colours bring out the light heartedness of pop art – Keith Haring employs this to present social contemporary issues in a relatable style

Contrasting colours used adjacently making it POP and creating an effect of maximalism.

KEITH HARING

Keith Haring's work is distinguished by his use of simple, cartoon-like figures. His style was influenced by pop-art, graffiti, and the emerging street culture. His art was deeply rooted in NYC as he intended for it to present social and political issues, keeping it simplistic and using symbols to keep it accessible to as many people as possible.

https://www.tate.org.uk/art/art-terms/p/pop-art#:~:text=It%20began%20as%20a%20revolt,saw%20around%20them%20every%20day
https://www.moma.org/learn/moma_learning/themes/pop-art/ https://lobopopart.com.br/portfolio/obras-de-arte-artista-lobo/ https://www.365rooms.be/blog/lobo-365/

POP ART IN NEW YORK CITY

Pop art originated in New York City as a revolt against the culture and traditional ideas of what art should be. This movement was to make art more connected to daily life, drawing inspiration from television, comics, advertisements, etc.

ELEMENTS OF POP ART IN MY OWN ART TO DEPICT NEW YORK CITY

* Candidate's artwork'

Patterns like Ben Day dots within regions – maximalist style, creates repetition.

The use of thick and thin black outlines bring out 3 dimensionality.

Use of vibrant contrasting colours and different patterns to bring out the hustle and bustle of NYC.

Figures inspired by Keith Haring – uniform outlines in black, vibrant colours

I used inks for vibrant, saturated colours and I used black ink with a pen to get as much control over the thick and thin outlines for details. Even though this artwork was time consuming and required focus to repeatedly produce intricate patterns, I thoroughly enjoyed this style.

Oil paintings by Shuchi Krishan

Female Indian artists have always intrigued me as I relate to them most. Being an Indian female myself, I like to see how Indian history and culture has impacted their artworks. I also like to see how they started and what inspires their art as that's what encourages me to keep creating.

Background

Shuchi Krishan was inspired by the vastness of the desert, its colour, the architecture and the culture of the people of Rajasthan. She loves to paint its heritage palaces and decorated pillars which have been getting eroded with time. Similarly, I was excited to paint the architecture of the place where I grew up. She also loves to paint the human figure - especially of women, deep in thought, synthesising some details of the architecture or landscape in the background. She is working in the forgotten Indian wash technique.

THE INFLUENCE OF CONTEMPORARY FEMALE INDIAN ARTISTS ON MY LIFE

What drew me to her work

Personally, I was invested in her feminist approach to depicting female individuals, deep in thought. Along with that, I like how she preserves old Indian artistic techniques that are almost forgotten in today's world. Her works give a sense of belonging and history to the viewer. According to me, someone who sees her painting for the first time feels a connection to historic Rajasthani culture and a sense of female independence and empowerment. As I have not learnt the oil painting techniques that are used by her, I used my own technique to create texture by painting in multiple layers and utilising the transparent quality of water colours.

Shuchi Krishan style

Shuchi Krishan specialises in the oil painting technique and the wash painting technique of the Bengal school of Arts. She also is an exponent of the ethnic art form 'Lepan'- murals. Lepan is a rural wall work from the desert state of Rajasthan. She executes exquisite Lepan murals on board with durable material and brings this rural Indian art form to modern interiors of homes, hotels and business centres around the globe.

www.jbpetithighschool.com www.shuchikrishan.com
www.indiaart.com www.indianartideas.in

Influence on my work

To represent my cultural background, I decided to use the school I went to for 12 years as I believe that it was in these 12 years where I grew to become myself. In school I often admired the Corinthian pillars and intricate gothic architecture I was surrounded by. My school was built by the British when India was under their rule and this reflects in the structure.

While painting my artwork, I paid attention to some of the aspects of Shuchi's painting that I wanted to bring out in my own style. One of the aspects was the angle of the portrait of the women. All the women face a source of light in her works, symbolising the women are on a forward moving path which also inspired me to choose my school motto "Ever Forward" as the title of my work. Creating a contrast by painting a dark shadow with watercolours is often daunting, but I learned that by working with layers, inspired by the Indian wash techniques, to reach the darkest shade slowly reduces the risk and creates a sense of depth. I also enjoyed the monochromatism in her paintings. From her paintings, the warm colours add a sense of heat to the painting alluding to Rajasthani climate. Thus, I followed warm and transparent layers of burnt sienna and raw umber to create the three dimensionality of the sculpted pillars.

Inspired by her focus on landscape beyond the pillars or windows in her work, I decided to paint a view representing hope. Deviating from her style a bit more over here, I used saturated colours to paint a colourful sunset sky and a rough textured sea, representing the beauty of the coexistence of smooth and rough times in the future.

Candidate's artist-influenced artwork

PONDICHERRY FROM MY EYES

EXPECTATION OF PONDICHERRY

Before I visited Pondicherry I heard about the French influences on the city, and I looked forward to the French architecture and visual impact on the city but when I reached I saw that it was only a part of the city that was slightly French and the rest of the city was like any other city in Tamil Nadu. The Tamil script everywhere and the bright colours used in boards and signs aren't a French feature. The use of familiar Indian logos and typical Indian road stands also added to the feel of the place. France in general looks clearer as there are lesser roadside stalls and the few that are there are decorated with softer colours. The French stalls follow more of a visual theme whereas in India the stalls use bold colours and fonts to attract customers.

PHOTOGRAPHY IN PONDICHERRY

In Pondicherry, I was inspired to capture the mood of the quaint town by capturing the colours and light the way I felt best reflected the calm and content air of the place. Experimenting with different settings on my camera, I found that shooting using the manual mode of White balance and exposure gave me the best results. Keeping an aperture between 5 and 6 and a quick shutter speed, I captured the moist, swampy climate that emphasised warm yellows that reflected the culture of the people there.

All photographs are candidate's photography using a dslr camera

Traditional South Indian rangoli - Kolam

Candidate's own work- paper craft

MY ARTWORK INSPIRED BY PONDICHERRY

Using paper made in Pondicherry I have expressed what I felt Pondicherry was to me visually. The main subject is a shell as the beach was the part of the city that impacted me the most. The shell I chose to use as my main subject has a radial form which reminded me of the rangolis made in south India using white rice powder. The technique of cutting out the shapes was inspired by an artwork I saw at the paper factory and the white translucent background is symbolic of the calm and peace in Pondicherry. The warm orange, gold and pink paper I've used reminded me of how I felt when I saw that Pondicherry was very hot and visually was mostly Indian. The second seashell is my response to the French side of Pondicherry which was subtle and only noticeable upon observation and exploration. The white paper in the centre has a leaf design which is symbolic of the natural aspect of Pondicherry. I chose to use paper and threads as my medium for my work because in Pondicherry they were the two factories I visited. From the Cluny Embroidery centre I learnt about intricate embroidery using single threads to create a blend between colours.

Pondicherry is known for its paper making factory where paper is made from cotton and the paper has all kinds of designs from natural dyes available. The factories also went one step ahead and made artistic pieces such as flowers, wall decoration and jewellery.

COMPOSITION IN MUSIC AND ART

Composition is the order in which a story is told. The use of a well organised overarching shape or pattern along with other elements contribute to a clearer expression of what the artist would like to share. In music, the listener often starts interpreting the piece as it starts and then the composition may take a turn which changes the interpretation of the listener and hence composition in music and art is received very differently. While painting abstractly while listening to a song I noticed that I was unable to begin before hearing the whole song first and getting an idea of what the composition was trying to say. When I painted “In the hall of the mountain king” by Edvard Grieg, my composition of my artwork made no sense to viewers until they heard the complete song and therefore the difference in the timing in which the art and music were received caused a lag in expression. Therefore, according to me another important element of composition when looking at art and music together would be the time period in which it is received by the audience. Below are 4 artworks I have created by listening to music and trying to capture the essence of the song keeping composition in mind.

The elements mentioned for composition in art can easily be used when talking about music and vice versa. However, the use of elements of composition in music of art are used very differently. For example, in music the element of patterns in composition is only effective after it repeats itself whereas in visual arts a pattern will stand out instantly.

*All artworks are candidate's own work using mediums that also reflect the music. In the Hall of the Mountain King the use of oil pastel crayons brings out the thick texture of an orchestra performing together while the use of watercolours in most other songs reflects the lack of depth I experience in pop songs

IN THE HALL OF THE MOUNTAIN KING

"In the Hall of the Mountain King" is a piece of orchestral music composed by Edvard Grieg in 1875 as incidental music. It was originally part of Opus 23 but was later extracted as the final piece of Peer Gynt, Suite No. 1, Op. 46. Its easily recognisable theme has helped it attain iconic status in popular culture, where it has been arranged by many artists.

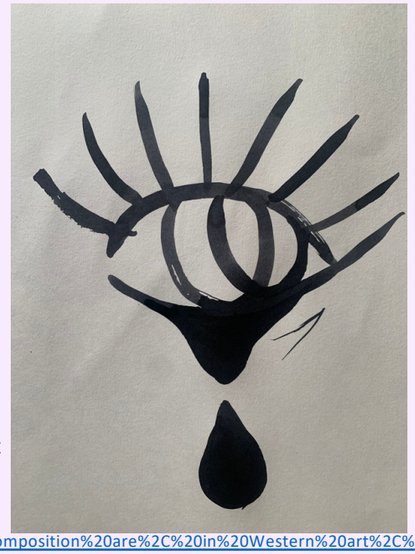
The composition of my artwork contains a staircase which is disproportionate and it neither has an end nor a beginning which is inspired by the song’s consistent increase in tempo. The negative space on the sides of the staircase creates a surrealistic mood or a sense of fantasy. This use of negative space also reflects on the composer’s use on the accompaniment which seems to set the tone of the song by percussively maintaining the key of that part. On close look, one can see the lines added on certain steps to add randomness as well as detail to the work.

NO WOMAN NO CRY

The song No Woman No Cry by Bob Marley begins with percussion and the crowd cheering. I have painted this song using many levels to resemble all the different layers of sounds heard in the song such as the audience, the lead voice, the percussion, etc. Bob Marley uses a few words in repetition in order to bring different people together therefore i have painted waves moving together to show the audience all relating to these few words. The black design in the centre is symbolic of the single loud voice which shapes the audience. The different lines of waves are pointing in different directions as the crowd is a mix of different people and who all interpret the music differently in context to their own lives but yet they all seem to have the same connection to the song at that point in time which allows the audience to swing together. The reassuring words of Bob Marley singing, “everything's gon na be alright” inspired the yellow, purple and blackish green background which oddly offers comfort and fun at the same time. The background almost reaches out to the audience by following the black design in the centre.

THE WAY I FEEL INSIDE

The song “The way i fell inside” by the zombies uses barely any backing track to their vocals. The song gives a sense of being a part of someone’s life as it starts with footsteps. It has a melancholic tone of longing and reasoning. This song reminds me of feeling alone and colourless. In my composition there is no background or use of multiple layers. There is a single eye looking in the centre as well as to the side to reflect the emotions of the singer’s contemplative state. The eyelashes and teardrop are definitely larger than scale to emphasize the difference between what something may look like on the outside as compared to what the singer feels on the inside which is not revealed entirely. The eye along with the lashes and teardrop fills almost the entire space of the artwork to show its importance, focus and its significance to the artist. The entire song has a flow to it that shows the transition from a certain grief in the beginning to a conclusion in the end. This song brings out the way composition in music can take someone on a journey whereas composition in art brings out instant emotions and relatability.



CAN YOU HEAR THE MOON

The song Bright side of the moon is a pop song that begins with a groovy electric guitar melody which is then accompanied by percussions and a single bass vocal verse which then elevates into a more energetic and fuller chorus where the question “can you hear the moon, howling back at you?” is repeatedly asked.

When I began painting this without having any context of the song, I began my composition by drawing a curve in the left of my page to literally resemble a moon which I then turned into a spiral. To me the spiral indicated the grooviness of the song and the long shaft like structure is symbolic of the singer’s low focused voice which gives direction to the audience. The song also had percussive layers which brought the song to life and therefore they support this shaft like structure from both sides. The overall composition of my artwork sheds light on the sizes of the shapes on my sheet of paper which show what aspects of the song stood out to me. The repetition is reflected in the symmetry of the artwork and the abrupt end of the song after the bridge can be related to the negative space on the right side; below and above the spiral. After painting this image, on looking at it from a distance I noticed that the shape as a whole resembles a ear canal along with the wavy lines inside the shaft representing sound waves entering the ear. This could have been an effect of the constant use of the word “hear” in the song. The composition reflects the theme of mystery through the way it leads the eyes into a never ending spiral.

https://marion.scot/the-elements-of-composition-in-art/#:~:text=The%20Elements%20of%20Composition%20are%2C%20in%20Western%20art%2C%20generally%20considered,%2C%20Proportion%2C%20Rhythm%20and%20Unity. https://www.artshebang.com/blog/like-music-visual-art-has-a-composition/

Creating mood of horror and mystery in photography using things in my environment

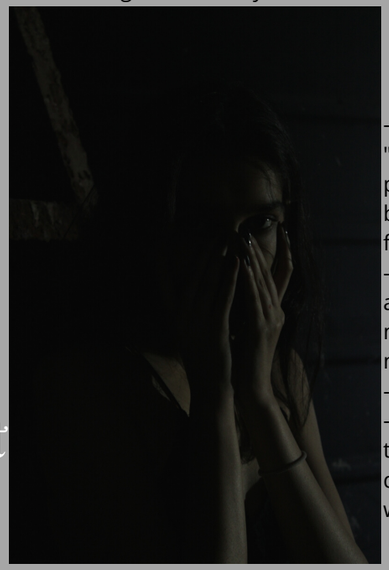
The 5 elements of horror, suspense, fear, violence, gore, and the supernatural., are used to create an atmosphere of horror and terror.

- The inappropriateness of playing the flute to a doll sitting on a staircase, creates an effect of unsettlement or psychological disturbance.
- Due to the flute's thin long shape, it is known to have a shrill, eerie sound. It is pointed directly towards the doll which emphasises the doll as the subject of the photo.
- Dolls are commonly seen in the horror genre. Humans are not programmed to be able to deal with 'fake faces.' The way the doll is positioned makes it seem like it is staring directly at the girl without any expression.
- When looking closely at the girl, one can see the stains of blood on her fingers which further inculcates the idea that she has a dangerous past. Her posture - facing the doll completely with the flute pointing to the doll and her elbows close to her body create an effect of focus and concentration of playing the flute to the doll. The fact that her face is hidden also gives more emphasis to the doll.
- The perspective of the photo also contributes to the creepiness as it seems to put the viewer in the position of an ominous observer, watching from a distance.
- The bright white light seems to be coming from the top right. Due to its intensity, there are deep contrasts and shadows. The shadow on the face of the doll also add to the mood.

- The expression on the girl's face show us a cruel, dangerous side to her. Her blank eyes staring directly at the camera along with her mouth in a threatening growl show us that she isn't afraid to harm you. This power in the girl is also highlighted due to the fact that she is already up on the ladder and has to look down at the viewer.
- The ladder looks old and rusted but yet sturdy as though it has been there for a long time.
- There is an intense source of light directly on the girl that spotlights her. The light reflecting on her shoulder makes it more evident than her face. This bright light also distinguishes the girl from the warmth of the background.
- The calm, soft sunset blend in the background adds a sense of mystery in this photo as it directly contrasts the black, villain subject and the dirty ladder and dark structure at the extreme left.
- The odd composition of the elements clustered towards the left of the photo also create a sense of unnatural eye movement for the viewer.
- This image has an overall sultry as well as scary mood. The outward pointing shoulder of the girl and the blend of warm and cool colours in the sky contribute to the sultriness. The sultry appeal of the girl is also brought out through her little black dress.

- The red candle light on the girl's face makes it stand out in the photo due to the contrast between red and dark brown earth tones and the contrast between the darker less saturated colours and the luminosity of the red.
- In this photo the focus lies on the girl's hands instead of her face. This causes discomfort for the viewer and is a common trick in horror photography.
- The girl is staring at the camera, expressionless. The blankness on her face do not give viewers a chance to determine anything about her and therefore it creates suspense. Her arms are stuck to the sides of her abdomen and her hair is unruly.
- In the background, the repetition of squares creates a sense of eeriness as the squares do not seem to begin or end anywhere.

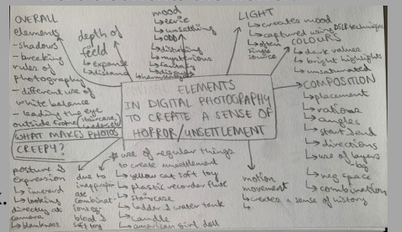
- The first thing that catches a viewer's eye in this photo is the contrast between the dull peaches and blacks and the deep crimson against soft yellow. This colour contrast allows the emphasis of the photo to lay on the soft toy and not the girl.
- Yellow is a colour that is normally associated with energy and happiness yet in this photo it symbolises the death of something innocent.
- The creepy element in the photo is the unnatural combination of human blood dripping from a non- living soft toy of a cat whose head is ripped off. This also gives us a sense of danger from the girl and adds a sense of anger or frustration to her character.
- Her face is expressionless with a long gaze at the camera which makes a viewer uncomfortable as humans rely on changing expressions.
- Her legs are neatly tucked in and her arms are close to her body, as though she was holding something normal that she possessed.



- In this photo, the most prominent aspect of it that makes it "creepy" is its lack of exposure. The intense highlights make parts of the subject stand out and provide a high contrast between the dark shadows. It interacts with humanity's fascination with the dark. A medium ISO and f number of 5.6
- The girl is again glaring at the camera while covering her face and her elbows are close her abdomen again. This further maintains her character of being mysterious, dangerous and not welcoming.
- Overall, the colours in this photo have a low saturation.
- The composition is also on trend with the other photos as they all have a large expressionless subject with some sort of direction or repetition in the background as seen again here with the slanting line created by a resting ladder and parallel lines on the right due to the placement of the black water tank.

In this image, I have digitally combined a few photos with the help of photoshop. Here, I have used techniques of horror in photography to produce the image including:

- using a motion blur effect to allude to ghostly figures in the hands on the left and in the figure on the right.
- The walls of the passage create a border for the photo, making the viewer feel more like a silent observer
- The monochromatic scheme here also adds to the mood and emphasises the red unrecognisable object.
- The lighting technique of a silhouette here disorients the viewer.



- https://expertphotography.com/fantasy-photography/
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- https://www.ipl.org/essay/Film-Techniques-in-Tim-Burtons-Grotesque-Horror-PCMCSA8AVYV#:~:text=Burton%20uses%20lighting%2C%20camera%20angles,in%20the%20film(s).
- https://www.verywellmind.com/fear-of-dolls-2671875
- https://www.history101.com/antique-dolls-creepy/
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- https://www.vice.com/en/article/wj4ngb/this-is-why-we-think-dolls-are-creepyutm_sourcetonicfbus

https://eloquentdoodles.myblog.arts.ac.uk/2019/01/24/fresh-guacamole-by-pes/
https://www.awn.com/animationworld/pes-talks-fresh-guacamole#:~:text=Western%20Spaghetti%20is%20about%20cooking,the%20sharpening%20of%20a%20knife

STOP MOTION ANIMATION

"A cinematographic technique whereby the camera is repeatedly stopped and started, for example to give animated figures the impression of movement."

PROCESS

Creating a story board based on a concept or story – in my stop-motion, I wanted to explain the concept of time through 3 different lenses, thus I experimented using multiple story boards to try different story lines, transitions of scenes, and ways to visualise theories using objects.

"Stop-motion is the only medium where you literally breathe life into an inanimate object, and it comes to life. It's a very magical thing." - Henry Selick

Coordination with timing and maintaining synergy in lighting, colours, and layout within a scene and in between scenes by making small adjustments between each photo. This was done by preparing sets in advance and using a tripod stand to click bursts of consistent photos

IMPROVEMENTS

Looking back at the film, I could improve the storyline to convey a more direct message to the audience. By taking photos of more consistent changes in the images I could also create a smoother flow to the stop motion by maintaining a constant rate of change of frames throughout the film. Having worked with a stop-motion animation before, one of my strengths was maintaining position and lighting, however, this was my first stop motion where I participated in the pictures as well which taught me how to manage my position as well as taking multiple photos to choose from for the final product.

https://www.awn.com/animationworld/pes-talks-fresh-guacamole#:~:text=Western%20Spaghetti%20is%20about%20cooking,the%20sharpening%20of%20a%20knife
https://www.videosoftdev.com/how-to-make-stop-motion-video

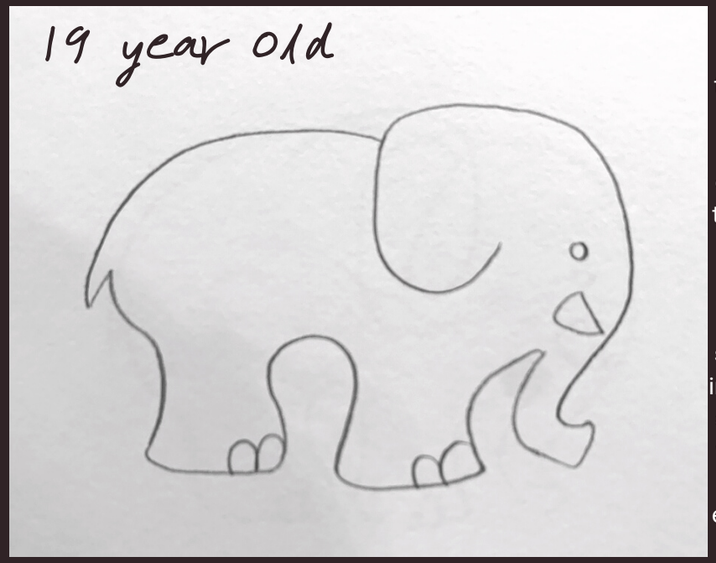
FRESH GUACAMOLE

This 2 minutes long Oscar-nominated film is the second part of a trilogy series created by PES.

Inspired by this scene of film, I too tried to make small adjustments to the set up to create a flow between frames. This short film also encouraged me to focus on the effect the film has on the audience.

Based on critiques and reviews of this film, we can see its positive impact on its audience by stimulating them using everyday objects in the preparation of guacamole. The unpredictable nature of the film kept viewers engaged. Similarly, I tried to use sand as a metaphor for time in my short film to engage my viewers through diverse ideas tying together the relative nature of time, the rhythmic nature of time, and the long-term effects of time. From this short film I also saw how the crisp 2 minutes could be used in a focused manner to express the concept of the film.

ART AND AGE

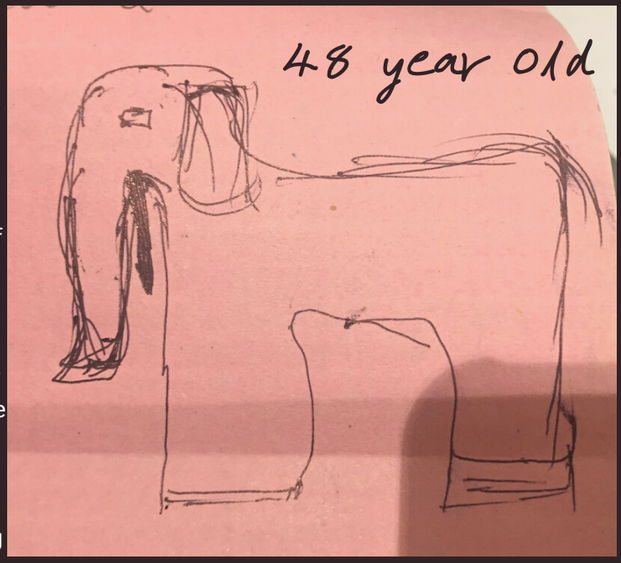


EFFECT OF AGE ON ART PRODUCED

As age increases the art produced by a person changes due to 2 main factors - mental and physical changes. The physical changes are attributed to the growing human body that initially is not strong enough, reaches a maximum and then again tends to decrease in terms of strength and control as the muscle begin to age as well. On the other hand, the mental changes are in a constant state of change due to the continuous external and internal stimuli that influence artworks being produces. However, mental changes, that is, changes in the composition, concept and creative aspects of the artwork are said to improve with age. This is because creativity is considered to be building something new using the connections existing in one's mind, therefore, with age the creativity simply increases due to an increased amount of connections.

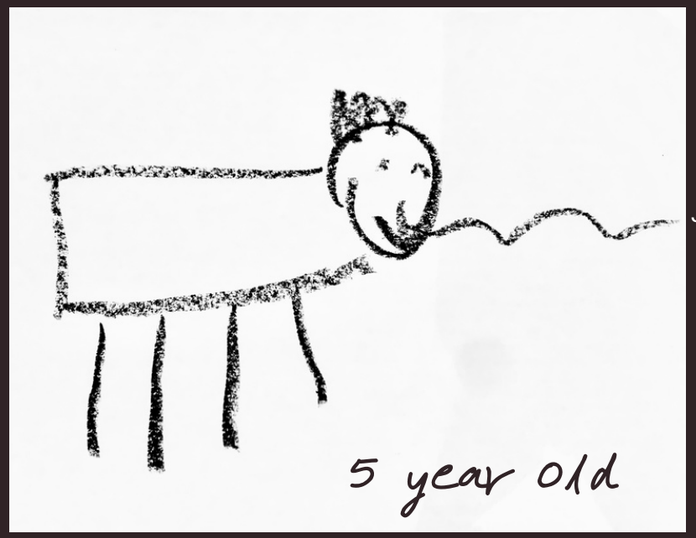
COMPARISON BETWEEN 19 YEAR OLD'S ELEPHANT AND 48 YEAR OLD'S ELEPHANT

While comparing the elephant of the 19 year old and 48 year old, while a lot of factors affect the final product, we can see the difference in form and line that indicate a difference in age. The elephant by the 48 year old is not a very familiar image while the elephant by the 19 year old is simply the elephant from the logo of the Ivory Ella brand. This supports the above research about creativity. The 48 year old would have seen multiple illustrations of elephants in his life, therefore, when asked to draw one he naturally sketched the resultant image of the elephant in his mind whereas the 19 year old's influence was from a single source. Here, while the line could represent mental stress or the confidence in drawing the elephant (because the 19 year old had seen the brand logo more often) it could also highlight the physical ability relating and familiarity with using grip strength which seems to be lacking in the 48 year old's as we can see the use of multiple strokes to create a single line.



5 YEAR OLD'S DRAWING OF AN ELEPHANT

In the 5 year old's elephant the highly simplified drawing can be attributed to multiple factors relating to age such as small hand size, less exposure and fewer experiences, and less muscular control. This led to a drawing with extremely few details and less accuracy, almost indistinguishable as an elephant. The choice of material here was an oil crayon - comfortable to use with smaller hands.

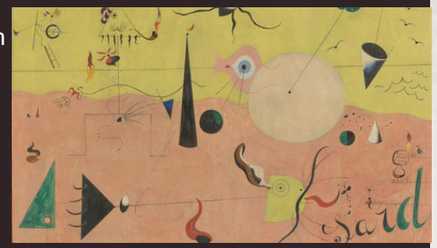


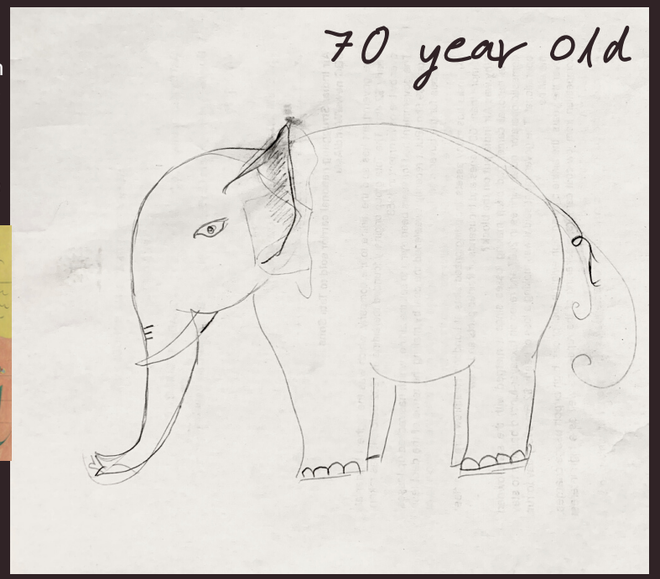
70 YEAR OLD'S DRAWING OF ELEPHANT

In the 70 year old's rendering of the elephant, contrasting from the 48 year old's we see more clarity and control over lines which are smooth and single stroked. This could be due to a clearer mental image of the end product of the drawing. Being the oldest one between the four, we can see the maximum details in this sketch that are considered to be more 'creative' than the 19 year old's as it isn't directly copied from a single image. However, increased age is also linked with a decrease in grip-strength and other physical abilities. Therefore, here we can see eraser marks when the drawing did not turn out according to the plan on the first try.

ARTIST JOAN MIRÓ

Joan Miró, the famous Spanish artist, believed that art is not limited by age. In fact, he once said, "The older I get, the more I feel like a child." Miró believed that artists should maintain a childlike sense of wonder and playfulness throughout their lives in order to create fresh and original works of art. Miró's art is often characterized by whimsical, childlike forms and bright, playful colors. He believed that these qualities were essential to creating art that was both engaging and meaningful. In his later years, he continued to experiment with new techniques and materials, showing that age was no barrier to creativity.





https://brainworldmagazine.com/artist-age-advantages/2/ https://www.physio-pedia.com/Effects_of_Ageing_on_Hand_Function https://www.moma.org/artists/4016

SAUL LEITER

“I happen to believe in the beauty of simple things. I believe that the most uninteresting thing can be very interesting.”

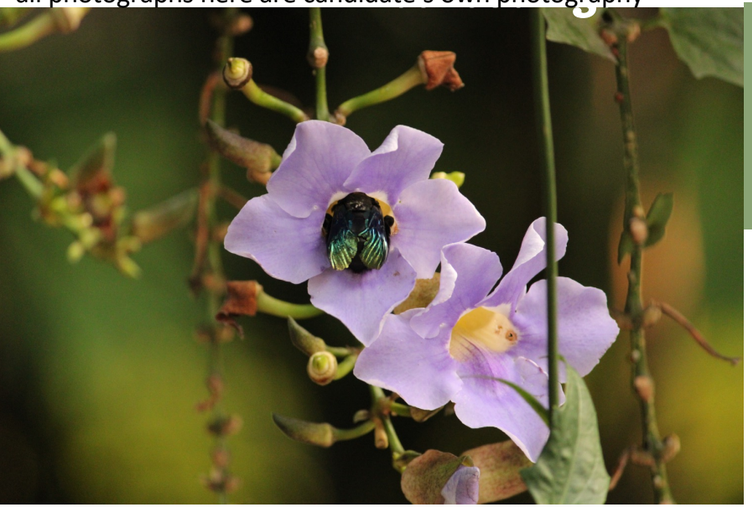
Saul Leiter was a photographer who stood at the crossroads of fashion, street photography, and abstract expressionism. Having started out as a painter, he was influenced by color, shapes and the camera as a tool for turning reality into his very own vision.

I was intrigued by his play with colours to find beauty in the regular. He believed that everything was worth photographing and that nothing had a purpose, therefore we find his photographs to often lack a dominant subject. Thus, his work is termed as ‘quasi-abstract’ because a focus on a subject exists, however it is not emphasized.

Saul Leiter’s photo

A photo I took inspired by Saul Leiter

*all photographs here are candidate’s own photography



I SPY

Inspired by the puzzle, “Where’s Waldo?” I enjoyed spotting things hidden in my surroundings and used photography to capture them. I was intrigued by the visual aspect of the art of hiding in plain sight.

CAMOUFLAGE

Camouflage is the use of any combination of materials, coloration, or illumination for concealment, either by making animals or objects hard to see, or by disguising them as something else. The green background causes the soft lilac flowers to stand out, preventing the metallic tinted bee’s camouflage in the green leaves.

PLACEMENT

In a regular setting on the exterior of a residential building, the position of the sun caused shadows seemingly providing bottom counterparts to the T-shirts left out to dry. The skill of composition and angle is necessary to not only capture the set up of the clothes but also to show it as a part of the layout of multiple windows, pipes, and ac boxes.

ABUNDANCE

Here I used the technique of abundance, hiding one amongst many. Amongst a flock of fluttering grey pigeons, a white one often gets lost in the crowd. The continuous movements, chaos, and repetition make it hard to spot.

SIZE and COLOUR

Here, the sculpted boar’s face almost goes by unnoticed in between the arches of a railway station in Mumbai. Every corner being decorated with intricate Victorian carvings, a small detail like this merges with the rest of the architectural ornament. This often happens due to the monochromatic nature of the sculpture

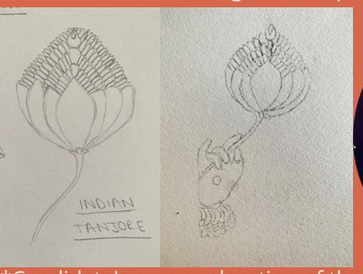
https://www.wallpaper.com/art/saul-leiter-street-photography https://adrianreynolds.ie/camouflage-art-of-hiding-in-plain-sight/#:~:text=Camouflage%20can%20be%20found%20in,April%2028%2C%202022

How do folk art styles tell us about the context of the region from which they originate - historic events, climate, lifestyle, etc. by analysing Tanjore art

BACKGROUND

Folk and traditional arts not only provide us pathways of discovery to history and heritage but open us up to a unique experience of cultural sharing with one another. By looking at a work of art's symbolism, colours, and materials, we can learn about the culture that produced it.

A folk art form from South India, Tanjore painting is a celebration of the region's rich artistic tradition, named after the town of Thanjavur in Tamil Nadu, India. Personally, having family roots in South India, I have seen Tanjore art all my life therefore, I was intrigued to explore its meaning and significance.



*Candidate's own exploration of the art form

*research found on candidate's trip to South India

MATERIALS

The usual materials used for the beautification of a Tanjore painting are cut glass, semi-precious gems, rich colours and laces along with diamonds, sapphires, and rubies as embellishments at its peak. To augment the gorgeous effect of the painting, **22 karat gold foils** are pasted in different parts of a figure while the rest of the areas are filled with day-glow colours that match up with the brilliance of the painting. Due to use of premier quality gold foil, an authentic Tanjore painting can last for generations without getting tarnished. This shows us the significance of Tanjore art during its time due to the high cost of materials to produce the artworks. Therefore, in my own artwork I used a thick gold paint to add texture and resemble real gold.

PROCESS

Creating a work of Tanjore is never an easy task. Such paintings require passion, perseverance, perfection and a span of 3 to 6 months by an artist to complete using 10 typical processes including preparing the canvas, embossing, and applying colours, gold and gems. Tanjore painting is a way of **expressing devotion**, truth and skill by an artist through his creation. Even though, I didn't follow the traditional processes, while experimenting with sketches, I realised the amount of precision and skill required to work on multiple layers of the intricate icons with different mediums.

COMPOSITION

The **composition** is static and two-dimensional with the figures placed within arches, curtains and decorative borders. The main subject/s usually occupies the centre of the painting and is surrounded by multiple secondary subjects and figures.

This style alludes to the heavy influence of other major South Indian styles of painting which were all deeply influenced by the Vijayanagar culture(1336-1646). The closest influences among these could be the Kalamkari and Tirupati paintings.

The composition also includes lots of patterns filling in patches and the adjacent placement of gold with red, green and blue and prussian blue that add to the expensive look of the painting. The composition ties together the lavish aspect of Tanjore art with the simplistic Vijayanagara layout. Similarly, in my composition, I decided to depict a single flower, however, if I wanted to follow the style more, I'd add background elements as well.

*photo taken by candidate of a tanjore painting in candidate's house that sparked an interest in learning more about the art form as a folk art style.

https://www.metmuseum.org/blogs/now-at-the-met/renaissance-portrait/blog/studying-art-from-the-past
https://courses.lumenlearning.com/culturalanthropology/chapter/folk-art/ https://everhart-museum.org/coming-together-through-folk-art/
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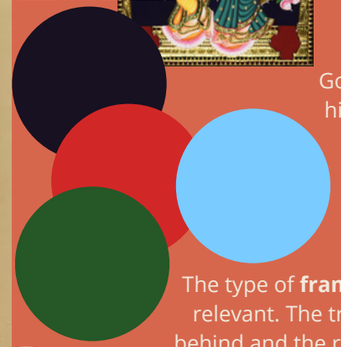
https://faculty.chass.ncsu.edu/mgfosque/ENG219/Siva.html https://www.mygoldguide.in/gold-tanjore-paintings-when-art-truly-precious

ICONOGRAPHY

Tanjore paintings often dealt with **themes** of episodes from Hindu Puranas, Sthala-puranas and other religious texts were visualised. Tanjore paintings are informed by a syncretic style, notable for its assimilation of the contemporary diverse cultural influences – Tamil, Telugu, Maratha, European, Deccani, Folk, etc. Bal Krishna, Lord Rama, and other gods, goddesses, saints, and subjects from Hindu mythology are also popular themes in Tanjore paintings. These themes allow us to know who the South Indians idolised and what other cultures influenced theirs. In my artwork, I used a lotus as I was intrigued by its relevance in Thanjuvar. The goddess Lakshmi is known to sit on top of a lotus and this often symbolises fertility and life, rooted in primordial waters. The lotus also naturally grows in South India due to the equatorial climate but is used in Tanjore art more to represent wealth. Thus the icons used can teach us about the beliefs of its creators.



COLOURS

The rich and vivid colours show us how tanjore was one of the more royal or expensive forms of folk art in South India. Red and dark blues and greens were preferred for the background as they made the gold and semi precious stones stand out more without taking away from the depth of the colour itself. This shows us the emphasis on aesthetics in Tanjore art. A common bright blue sky reflects the purpose of Tanjore art - to bring a room to life using beauty and depicting clear skies symbolic of the euphoric state of Thanjuvar for their Gods and Godesses. Lord Vishnu is often represented in the colour blue to reflect his calm and cool demeanour and his association with the sea and the sky, hinting at the importance of the sea in Tamil culture and the environment in the coastal state of Tamil Nadu.

TRADITIONAL FRAME

The type of **frame chosen reflects the purpose** of art and the setting in which it is relevant. The traditional jet black frame creates a stark contrast between the wall behind and the rich gold and colourful semiprecious stones. The frame also acts as a mark to show the value of the painting inside. A fancier, more intricately carved frame is symbolic of a painting of a high value. As we can see through the extensive use of gold, semi precious stones and royal colours that they were made to beautify and increase the royal look of rooms. In olden days, Tanjore paintings were placed in dark temple shrines by emperors.

HUMAN FIGURES

The **human figures** seen in Tanjore art are a reflection of what humans in South India considered as beauty standards. This is because the purpose of Tanjore art was to add beauty and to decorate a room, it shows their idea of what an idea body looked like. The themes of the painting are often religious and therefore the Gods represented are considered to be of ideal body image. In Tanjore art, the bodies are depicted to be fair and round. This also reflects on a wealthy lifestyle where the high standards of people ate lavishly as a sign of wealth and luxury.

ATTIRE

The **attire of subjects** in the painting show us what was worn by the wealthy people in South India at those times. The loose 'lungis' worn in Tanjore paintings also hint at the hot and humid climate in Thanjuvar. The texture of the fabric seems to be thin and soft, as we can see through the folds and fall of fabrics depicted. The shading in the fabrics in this painting that show the way the light falls on the fabric can be used to identify the thickness of the fabric. The heavy use of gold and precious gems in the attire also indicate the conditions of the idols depicted in these artworks.

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CONCEPT

To discover who I am, I started by making a mind map of everything I associated with myself. My teacher suggested that I make a full size outline of myself so that I can express who I am more wholly and understand the physical proportions of my body better. After brainstorming and experimenting, I tried to capture my essence by making a collage style acrylic painting, connecting my physical self to the person I am inside by associating physical parts of my body with aspects of the person I am inside. To make these connects, I also read about the Indian theory of chakras and their significance and purpose of placement in the human body. I learnt about how experimentation is important before starting any artwork as a change in idea is easier to execute in a smaller rendering of the piece.

HEAD

In and above my head I've depicted an explosion of my thoughts and represent how my head bursts with ideas. The large eye in the centre of my face shows how I prioritise what I see and notice around me. As pink is my favourite colour, the use of pink shows that this mindset of mine is my most common, everyday mindset. For me, the colour pink resembles comfort and versatility. The eye as well as the butterfly are symbolic of tattoos. This is to show their longevity and individuality. The butterfly is how i feel like i speak at times, yet it's not dainty and plain but full of designs and character, butterflies also tend to fly into things and when one thinks of a smart animal, one does not think of a butterfly. Similarly, I feel like what I say is not always aligned with what I think.

SHOULDERS

The waves represent me in my natural element. Spending hours at a beach, or in any element of nature, I feel calm within the activity. I've tried to capture the feeling of the constant intense movement of the waves along with the repeating sound of water crashing against the sand through the use of minute white splashes on the deep blue wave.

CHEST

Like a tiger, I believe I am a calm person, and when I feel necessary, I can be fierce and confident. According to me, a tiger is my spirit animal because like, a tiger is a symbol of India, strength and beauty. The stripes and sunset colours distinguish a tiger from any other animal, adding to its character.

WHOAMI?

Using a tracing of my body, I explored who I am through different aspects each body part is symbolic of.

RIGHT ARM

The right arm is my more disciplined side that practices classical music. Being right-handed, the contrast of black against the white shows the lack of wildness while the non-parallel lines allude to the joy within the bars of rules and routines.

LEFT ARM

The patterns in my left arm are symbolic of my creativity. I to fill in the large circle of the sun and the long trunks of the palm trees with radial and linear designs that remind me of how I like to add beauty and complexity to the simple portions while maintaining a cold blue background for balance.

RIGHT LEG

The right leg is filled with illogical shapes in completely random colours. This is symbolic of my sense of humour as it shows the overall aesthetic satisfaction of colour combinations that have no reason behind them and are not regularly found. The pop of neon yellow between a dull blue and purple adds an element of surprise. The smoothness of the curves forming the shapes in the leg also represent the mental freedom I associate with comedy.

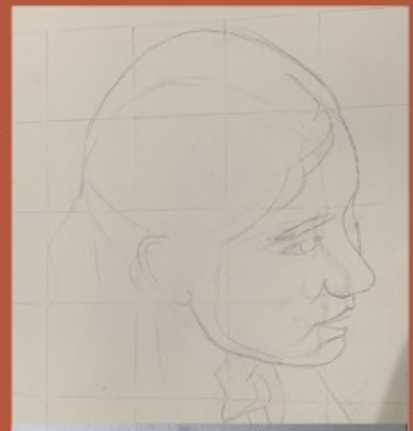
LEFT LEG

The left leg is a collage of my fears portrayed in terms of things that I love.
In the citrus fruit I've shown how I'm scared of being unhealthy without knowing through the almost unnoticeable texture of the flesh of the fruit that symbolises its effect on the texture of teeth if in contact for a long time.
The strawberry is significant for enjoyment and my fear is of not enjoying doing something that's good for me as that may lead me to stop.
The watermelon represents my fear of not drinking enough water. Here, the neatly arranged line of seeds show my belief in regularity and practice.
The band-aids are a representation of literal injury and accidents.
I love flamingoes not only for their pink colour but also for the way they stand in the water and can migrate whenever needed. Here, through the simplicity and lack of realism and detail in my rendering of the flamingo I've tried to make it seem artificial. Fearful of the depreciation of our planet, I am haunted that more artificial flamingoes exist than real ones.
Even though there's nothing I enjoy more than a typical horror movie, the smiling ghost represents my irrational fear of the existence of another layer of life.
TPWK (Treat People With Kindness) is a slogan of the famous singer- Harry Styles. It's important to me as I often fear that I don't act kind enough.
Spongebob (being a character that constantly laughs) shows my fear of taking things too seriously which I showed using a depiction of the cartoon with a tense expression.
The Mickey Mouse ears portray my fear of growing old too quickly.
The yin-yang portrays my fear of imbalance. The inability to fit the entire yin-yang here or equal parts of its two contrasting sides due to the shape of the leg emphasises the reality of how tough it is to achieve a perfect balance in human life.
The composition of this leg is crowded like the rest of the body with almost no negative spaces.

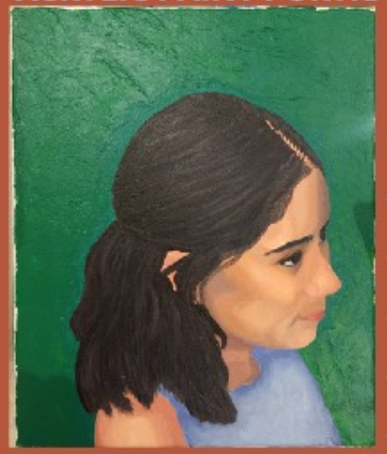
PROCESS

OIL PAINTING - For this portrait, I used a reference image of my cousin that I took of her. I then made rough sketches and newspaper cutouts to decide the size and shape of the canvas I wanted to use. When painting portraits, I find it easier to objectively observe someone's small movements and study their features than to paint myself. I was inspired by portraits by Rembrandt because I was intrigued by the drama within the contrasts, depth and realism. Yet, painting in a Rembrandt style requires lots of skill and years of practice. For me, this painting was my experimentation with oil paints. Initially, even though I found it tough to manage the time the paint takes to dry, I learnt to use it to my advantage by using it to blend colours and achieve a smooth texture.

ACRYLIC PAINT - I then attempted a self-portrait, using a smaller canvas and acrylic paint. Experimenting with the medium on paper before painting the portrait gave me the confidence to go ahead, however I was unable to recreate the same process on the canvas. After this exercise, I learnt the importance of experimentation using the same material as well. The prominent texture of the canvas made the paint dry quicker, thus making it harder to achieve skin like textures. I realised that using single pigment oil paints and linseed oil for controlled transparency for realistic paintings was easier also because of the ease with which I could create precise shades as compared to acrylic paints that often dried while working on my palate itself, thus I wasn't able to maintain consistent skin tones.



ACRYLIC PAINT PORTRAIT



Portraits and Identity

OIL PAINT PORTRAIT

DIFFERENCES BETWEEN OIL PAINTS AND ACRYLIC PAINTS

- **The drying time and blending - The high drying time of oil paints allowed me to work on creating smooth, realistic, skin-like textures**
- **Opacity - The control of opacity while working with linseed oil allowed me to work in layers**
- **Colours and mixing - Using oil paints I could mix more accurate shades there are fewer ready colours that are used**
- **Thickness - Again, using linseed oil I could control the consistency of my paint, making it thinner in places where i'd like to add more details**
- **Sheen - compared to acrylic paints, oil paints have more a sheen to it after drying, preserving the feel of the painting**

'Self Portrait'
Candidate's own work
Acrylic on Canvas
September 2021

POST PAINTING REFLECTION

After spending hours trying to achieve a realistic look, I also learnt the importance of pure, focused observation. When more time is spent on observation, the proportions and dimensions as well as colours and lines become easier to recreate with more accuracy and stead. This skill has also become useful in other areas of knowledge because it essentially inculcates concentration. I now see how most artworks are a reflection of what one observes. I also found that observing images in black and white was beneficial in judging the values of shades.

'Profile Picture'
Candidate's own work
Oil on Canvas
January 2021

CONCEPT OF IDENTITY

Last year I had painted the oil paint portrait following the theme of identity. I tried to explain and spread awareness of my belief that to be yourself you have to do what feels correct, not what you think is expected of you.
Using a circular canvas and a composition focusing on the face in the centre, the painting resembles a profile photo often used on social media. In my opinion, profile photos promote users to select one image through which they show the world who they are, thus promoting people to try to live up to this one image. Using black sunglasses on the subject's head I tried to bring in a contemporary aspect to the sombre colours of the portrait.
I chose to use an image of my sister as reference as I looked forward to painting the details in the seemingly simple photo. For example, spending hours depicting the parts of the room reflected in her eyes and the creases on her lips. However, in my next realistic oil painting, I hope to use more accurate colours and try a new technique to depict the texture of hair and light falling from one side.

DOLLHOUSE

CONCEPT

To get a better idea of who I am from the outside I asked a few people to answer a few questions about me. From their answers I noticed that there were certain aspects of me that aren't fundamental qualities of mine, yet add to my personality. Each room represents one aspect, the central room alluding to my most constant state while other rooms represent my love for cartoons, planning, deep conversations, introspection, creating, adventure, and nature, using symbolic imagery to express each. The dollhouse represents me in the sense that the rooms can always be re-decorated as my preferences change however, the wooden dollhouse structure remains the constant.

STRUCTURE

The exterior of the dollhouse is pink to remind the viewer of a traditional stereotypical little girl's doll house, however the pink used isn't a traditional pastel shade but a bright and vibrant one to represent my feminity. The grey framework is a neutral middle ground that evens out and forms a balance which prevents all the colours from clashing. On a metaphorical level these colours symbolise parts of my personality.

*Candidate's artwork
'Vani's House"
November 2021

ATTIC

In the uppermost room or attic, the two beanbags and the coffee table with the dark wood and the dark view outside the window remind me of late-night conversations which are honest and personal. This represents my open and non-judgemental aspect as when I have such conversations, I find myself to be understanding empathetic. The beanbags symbolise comfort and the dark wood symbolises history. I made the beanbags by sewing together cut pieces from old socks which formed the typical beanbag shape when filled with beans. A sense of comfort is brought about in this room through the symmetrical layout and the combination of warm wooden tones with the deep blue of the night.

SHREK ROOM

This room refers to a scene from my favourite movie - Shrek. In the movie, I admired the attention to small details. In this scene, Shrek wants to eat a candle lit dinner so he conveniently removes his ear wax from his iconically shaped ear which he then uses as a candle. I made the model of Shrek's ear and the candle using hard drying putty sealant to build the shape, using things I was about to throw away as a base. While making the candle, I used a real candle inside the clay so it could actually be lit if wanted. Looking back at this room, I could improve the composition to bring in more of the Shrek aesthetic by painting the walls to look more like Shrek's house in the swamp or by adding more elements or characters from the movie.

MIRROR ROOM

The empty room with mirror walls is a reminder to reflect on your age by looking at yourself. When looking in the mirror the first thing I see is how much older I have become. The many mirrors perpendicular and parallel to each other are fun to look at and therefore I want people to be reminded to be carefree and have fun by rekindling the child inside. Initially, I wanted to add a slide in this room to emphasise the element of fun, however my plan to make it out of a melted plastic knife didn't work out on experimentation. Now, if I could add the slide, I would try to make it out of a ruler or simply paper.

ADVENTURE ROOM

In the next room there is a large tree in the centre with colourful climbing holds. This room represents fun and spontaneity. The blue ceiling and floor show so how when people indulge in fun and adventure they tend to not be stressed or think about too many things. The topical walls represent travelling as according to me, this fun and venturous side of me is most active then. The tree in the centre with the rock-climbing holds emphasise physical adventure and readiness to try new things even though you may not like them initially. In this room, I think the colours work well with the mood of the room and the tree in the centre with a busy background represents a lack of walls and therefore, a sense of freedom.

CENTRAL ROOM

The most normal looking room in the centre is symbolic of a bedroom. The bedroom is simple, pretty and comfortable. For me I am most comfortable when I have space alone. This room with a large window and curtains is a bedroom that I would like to have where I could just look out and observe all day. Again, all the fabrics I've used here are cut out from old clothes. I used an old kitchen sponge as the mattress for the bed and painted a small cardboard box for the platform below it.

THE PARK

And lastly the room to the bottom right represents a park near my house which is right next to the sea. This room represents how I try to be healthy and my love for nature. When I go to the park to exercise, I often find myself gazing at the sky above or going near the sea to watch the waves crash against the rocks. The weights placed mid the shells, flower and ladybirds symbolise the interconnection of health and nature. In this room, I think it could be bettered by making more use of the height. Even though I wanted to emphasise the importance of being outdoors and seeing the vast sky above, I could have included more of the health aspect to this room by using the space more effectively. All the materials in this room again were plucked off of gift decorations and velcro for the grassy texture.

CRAFT ROOM

In this room the walls look like a fabric scrapbook and in the middle a pair of handmade pyjamas are hanging. This room is the show my love for pyjamas as well as how I find crafting relaxing. All the fabrics in this room are from old clothes of mine and it represents how I love saving old things and making use of them later. To make this room, I used my sewing machine to make each wall and the pyjamas, and then I used fabric glue to stick it to the wood.

PROCESS

After collecting data by speaking to people and then synthesising it to build the concept, I visualised each of the aspects as room. Once I had made sketches of each room, I drew a layout for the dollhouse, first a small sketch and then the real size, to accommodate all the rooms. Then I asked a carpenter to make the structure for me which I then painted and worked on one room at a time, using as many materials I could find in my house itself to be more sustainable. Other than the dollhouse itself, the only materials I bought for it were the mirrors and the sealant putty.

CONTROL ROOM

Moving on to the room with a light bulb, this room represents my thoughts. The ceiling and floor covered in a plethora of lists shows the extent of my need for it. In this room the light bulb is symbolic of the ideas that overflow on the lists. There are also keypads on the walls of this room which represent the control I feel by making out-of-control lists. The keypads I used here were the defected pieces from a factory. Reflecting on it, the yellow of the post-it got tied together will with the black of the keypad due to the dull light green walls that reduced the stark contrast.